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Aliaksei Yaletski

Founding CTO · Engineering Manager · Tech Lead

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Hands-on engineering leader with two decades of experience. My work centers on building **high-autonomy teams** with **strong engineering culture** and **product ownership**. I see team structure, processes, and architecture as parts of the product and evolve them together. My technical expertise ranges from deterministic game logic in C++ to cloud-based payment systems in Python, and from code analysis to AI-based systems.

Hire Me When

You start a product from zero

I'll bootstrap the team, architecture, and processes so we can validate hypotheses early and scale or pivot with less rework. I'll prototype where needed to inform design decisions.

You need long-term product success

I'll evolve the team, architecture, and processes in line with long-term goals and risks. I'll establish knowledge flow, quality automation, and high-frequency delivery required for sustained growth.

Work Style

As a manager

I foster self-governed, self-regulated, remote-first teams with transparent decision-making and asynchronous workflows.

As a technical leader

I stay directly involved in architecture and critical systems, and mentor through shared ownership, design work, and deep code review.

Work

2024-2026 Professional sabbatical

R&D

Technical Writing

Python

TypeScript

Rust

PostgreSQL

LLMs

Read [the full report](#) on my blog.

- Created [Feeds Fun](#), a news reader with LLM-based tagging — **nearly 400 GitHub stars**.
- **Refined engineering management approach** via [essays on team autonomy and scientific practices](#).
- **Built AI coding-agent harness tools**: [Donna](#), [DepMesh](#) — published [findings](#).
- Completed the [World Builders](#) program in entertainment IP development — published [essays](#).
- [Explored Rust](#) with an emphasis on game-logic programming and system reliability.

2022-2023 Multi-provider payments platform for Palta portfolio startups

Palta

Engineering Manager

Tech Lead

Engineering Processes

Hiring

Onboarding

Mentoring

AWS

Python

TypeScript

PostgreSQL

Redis

FastAPI

Led the design and delivery of a payments platform from concept to production. The platform included subscriptions, entitlement management, discounting, unified analytics, admin tooling, SDKs, and resilient payment flows supporting disputes, refunds, provider fallback, and failure recovery.

- The platform was **integrated into 3 portfolio companies**.
- **Built and led a remote-first core team of 7 engineers**.
- Hired, onboarded, and mentored engineers, gradually transferring system ownership to them.
- Established [an RFC-driven approach to evolving architecture and engineering processes](#).
- Designed resilient payment flows with idempotency, safe retries, provider fallback, and state recovery.
- Established a delivery process with **multiple releases per week and on-demand feature shipping**.
- **Identified concurrency bugs in major Python libraries** ([redis-py](#), [psycopyg](#)) and prevented them from affecting our systems; related redis-py issues later caused [an OpenAI outage](#).

2019-2021 Professional sabbatical

Technical Writing

Game Design

Python

Julia

Deep Neural Networks

Read [the full report](#) on my blog.

- Strengthened expertise in backend architecture, code analysis, and quality control.
- **Refined my game-design approach** via essays on worldbuilding, game mechanics, and MMO design.
- Explored Julia by prototyping a DSL for procedural generation.
- Refreshed fundamentals of mathematical analysis and deep neural networks.
- **Published 141 essays** on technology, gamedev, and thinking — longer than the first Harry Potter novel.

2017-2019 Mobile game **My Cafe** — 50M+ installs as of September 2021

Melsoft
Games

Tech Lead

Linux

Python

PostgreSQL

Redis

Twisted

Django

Graphite

Prometheus

Grafana

Ansible

Owned backend architecture and core service development. Modernized legacy systems for scale and stability; advised on architecture and algorithm design.

- **Optimized the backend to handle 1.5M RPM (25k RPS)** with stable latency and low error rates.
- Stabilized payment processing and analytics logic, **reducing payment-related errors to zero**.
- Implemented scalable profile sharding, **reducing database load tenfold**.
- Implemented GDPR support on short notice.
- Adapted backend logic to meet Chinese market requirements.
- **Introduced automated testing as a development practice.**
- Partnered with an analyst to develop systems for marketing campaigns and A/B testing.

2015-2017 Mobile games **Toy Defense 1, 2, and 3**

Melsoft
Games

Tech Lead

Hiring

Onboarding

Mentoring

Linux

Python

MySQL

Redis

Twisted

Django

Fabric

Graphite

Grafana

Fully owned the unified backend of 3 games. As an expert, advised colleagues on infrastructure, architecture, and algorithms.

- **Resurrected the legacy game backend.**
- Developed a payment service reused by another team for a different product.
- **Introduced practices for automated testing, CI/CD, and metrics collection.**
- Migrated the project from SVN to Git.
- Partnered with an analyst to develop systems for game metrics collection and marketing campaigns.

2012-2015 Browser text-based MMO game "**The Tale**"

The Tale

Founder

Engineering Processes

Team Formation

R&D

Game Design

Marketing

Monetization

Community Management

Volunteer Coordination

Linux

Python

JavaScript

PostgreSQL

Redis

RabbitMQ

Django

Built and operated my own product from scratch, from prototyping through release to shutdown. Took on all roles, from backend and frontend development to game design, community management, and marketing.

- **Reached 90k+ trial, 30k+ registered, and 2k+ paying players** with localization only in Russian; activity peaked at 5k MAU and 2k DAU.
- **Built a core team and coordinated volunteers.**
- **Designed advanced game systems:** a player-shaped persistent world, player-driven economy and governance, autonomous NPCs with dynamic personalities, and player-authored entity lore.
- Implemented automated quality control, **enabling development without dedicated QA**.
- Developed advanced procedural generators for [Russian text](#), [quests](#), and the world map.
- Open-sourced [the code](#) and [the game lore](#).

2010-2012 Web portal **World of Tanks**, meta-game "Clan Wars"

Wargaming

Senior Developer

Mentoring

Linux

Python

JavaScript

PostgreSQL

Memcached

RabbitMQ

Django

jQuery

Owned the entire web portal codebase, including registration, player and clan profiles, clan management, player statistics, ratings, tournaments, the clan metagame, news, and internationalization.

- Transitioned with the team from client-side C++ to Python backend development and built the portal for one of the most successful online games.
- Expanded ownership from several subsystems to the entire portal.
- Partnered with a colleague to design the clan metagame's UI/UX.
- Defined requirements for CAPTCHA and password quality checks.

2009-2010 Real-time strategy game **Order of War**

Wargaming

Middle Developer

Windows

C++

internal game engine

Optimized code and developed game logic, including critical GUI elements.

- Doubled command-queue throughput between the game logic and graphics engine during probation.
- Designed and implemented the unit-formation UI, central to gameplay and UX.

2008-2009 Automated migration of Linux systems from physical machines to VMs

ltransition

Middle Developer

Linux

Perl

C

Xen

VMware

Automated virtual hardware configuration based on physical machine specifications.

- Introduced automated testing as a development practice.

2007-2008 GUI for VoIP telephone

ltransition

Junior Developer

Windows

C++

wxWidgets

Education

2004-2009 — Specialist (equivalent to an MSc), Systems Engineering

Belarusian State University of Informatics and Radioelectronics

Department of Artificial Intelligence, Faculty of Information Technologies and Control

Languages

Russian native

English fluent

Code examples

[tiendil/feeds.fun](#)

News reader with LLM-based tagging and rule-based ranking.

Interesting Facts

- All em dashes in this CV are human-made.
- Won a second diploma (3rd place) in the quarter-final of ACM ICPC Western Subregion 2006.
- I regularly publish [long-form essays](#) about complex topics I have studied and questions where I have a strong opinion.